

HTML5 Semantic Tags

Inline vs Block Elements • Semantic Structure • Accessible HTML

1. Inline vs Block Elements in HTML

In HTML, elements are broadly categorized as **inline** or **block** based on how they behave in the document flow.

Block Elements

Block elements **start on a new line**, take up the **full available width**, and can contain other block and inline elements.

Common Block Elements

```
<div>
<p>
<h1> to <h6>
<section>
<article>
<ul>, <ol>, <li>
```

Example

```
<div>
  <h2>This is a heading</h2>
  <p>This is a paragraph inside a div.</p>
</div>
```

Inline Elements

Inline elements **do not start on a new line**. They usually take up only as much width as necessary and are commonly used for smaller portions of content inside block elements.

Common Inline Elements

```
<span>
<a>
<strong>, <em>
<img>
<code>
```

Example

```
<p>This is a <strong>bold</strong> word and
<a href="#">this is a link</a>.</p>
```

Inline vs Block — Quick Comparison

Feature	Block Elements	Inline Elements
New line	Yes	No
Width	Full available width	Width of content only
Nesting	Can contain block and inline elements	Generally used within text/content flow

2. What Are Semantic Tags?

Semantic tags **clearly describe the meaning of the content** they contain. They help developers and browsers understand the structure of a page.

For example, `<div>` does not communicate what its content means, while `<header>` clearly identifies a page or section header.

3. Common Semantic Tags

Tag	Purpose
<header>	Top section of a page or section
<nav>	Navigation links
<main>	Main content of the page
<section>	A standalone section
<article>	Self-contained content such as a blog post
<aside>	Sidebar or extra information
<footer>	Bottom section of a page or section

4. Example Usage

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>Semantic Page</title>
</head>
<body>
  <header>
    <h1>My Website</h1>
  </header>

  <nav>
    <a href="#">Home</a> |
    <a href="#">About</a> |
    <a href="#">Contact</a>
  </nav>

  <main>
    <section>
      <h2>Welcome</h2>
      <p>This is the welcome section.</p>
    </section>

    <article>
      <h2>Blog Post</h2>
      <p>This is a blog post inside an article tag.</p>
    </article>
  </main>

  <aside>
    <p>This is a sidebar with related links.</p>
  </aside>

  <footer>
    <p>Copyright © 2025</p>
  </footer>
</body>
</html>
```

- TIP
- **Semantic tags improve accessibility and SEO.**
 - **Prefer meaningful semantic elements when they accurately describe the content.**
 - **Use generic <div> and when no more appropriate semantic element fits.**

Quick Takeaway

Block elements structure larger sections and normally begin on a new line. **Inline** elements flow within content. **Semantic** elements communicate what different parts of a page mean.